

Standalone Islamic Learning Assistant

Project Proposal for a New Product Build

Core Decision

This proposal removes all AvatarOS dependency from the original plan and postpones scholar-reviewed certification to a later trust layer. The first goal is to build the working product: Quran search, Hadith search, Islamic learning assistance, basic source references, and a strong no-fatwa safety guard.

Field	Details
Document type	Project proposal
Product	FaithBrains
Version	1.0
Date	July 2026
Status	New standalone project scope

Prepared to start a new project without platform dependency or day-one scholar operations.

1. Executive Summary

FaithBrains should now be treated as a standalone Islamic learning product, not as an AvatarOS-dependent platform product. The first build should focus on a simple, useful, and safe product that helps users search and understand Quran, Hadith, and Islamic learning topics through clear explanations and basic source references.

The scholar-review layer should not block the first build. Instead, scholar review, certified citations, institutional approval, and governance dashboards should be added later after the core product is working and real usage patterns are understood.

Recommended MVP Direction

Build a clean web application where users can ask Islamic learning questions, search Quran and Hadith, receive simple explanations, see references, save topics, and receive safe deferrals when a question requires a fatwa or qualified scholarly judgement.

2. Revised Product Positioning

FaithBrains is an AI-powered Islamic learning assistant for users who want simple, referenced explanations of Quran, Hadith, and Islamic topics. It is designed for learning, study support, and source discovery.

FaithBrains is not a religious authority, not a fatwa engine, and not a replacement for qualified scholars. In the first version, it should be positioned as a learning and reference assistant only.

Positioning Area	New Direction
Product category	Standalone Islamic learning assistant
Primary value	Fast, simple, referenced Islamic learning
Authority level	Learning support only; no fatwa or binding rulings
Trust method in MVP	Basic Quran/Hadith references, transparent limits, and safety guardrails
Trust method later	Scholar-reviewed answers, certified content, and institution controls

3. What Is Removed from the Original Plan

The original document positioned FaithBrains as a product running on AvatarOS and reused AvatarOS for memory, real-time voice, avatar, orchestration, multi-tenant control, billing, and observability. For a new independent project, these platform dependencies should be removed.

Original Element	Decision for New Project	Reason
AvatarOS dependency	Remove from MVP	Avoid platform complexity and start the product independently.
Voice and avatar interface	Remove from MVP	Text-first product is faster, cheaper, and easier to validate.
Multi-tenant enterprise control plane	Remove from MVP	Not needed until institutions are ready to pay.
Platform billing and metering	Replace later with simple subscriptions	MVP can launch before complex billing.
Day-one scholar review board	Move to later phase	Useful, but it should not delay product

Original Element	Decision for New Project	Reason
		validation.
Scholar-certified citations	Move to later phase	Start with basic source references, then certify later.

4. What Must Stay in the Product

Even without AvatarOS and without day-one scholar review, FaithBrains must keep its core identity: Quran consultation, Hadith consultation, Islamic learning, references, and safety boundaries.

- Quran search and explanation with surah and ayah references.
- Hadith search and explanation with collection and hadith reference where available.
- Islamic learning assistant for beginner-friendly topic explanations.
- Basic references with every source-based answer.
- No-fatwa guardrail that refuses ruling-style answers and redirects users to qualified scholars.
- User learning history, saved topics, and guided study paths.
- Report/correction option for users to flag mistakes or unclear responses.

5. Target Users

User Type	Main Need	Product Response
General learner	Understand Islamic topics in simple language	Plain explanations with references and related topics.
Student of knowledge	Find Quran/Hadith references quickly	Searchable source database with citations and saved notes.
New Muslim	Learn basics gently and clearly	Beginner paths, simple wording, and careful safety boundaries.
Educator or imam	Prepare teaching material faster	Source discovery, topic summaries, and exportable notes later.

6. MVP Scope

6.1 MVP Features

Feature	Description	Priority
Chat question answering	User asks Islamic learning questions in natural language.	P0
Quran lookup	Search by topic, surah, ayah, or keyword.	P0
Hadith lookup	Search by topic, keyword, collection, or number where available.	P0
Referenced answers	Display Quran/Hadith references below the response.	P0
No-fatwa safety guard	Refuse or redirect ruling-style, sensitive, or high-risk religious questions.	P0
Learning paths	Beginner-friendly topics such as prayer, fasting, Quran basics, character, and daily duas.	P1
Saved topics	Users can save answers, references,	P1

Feature	Description	Priority
	and lessons.	
Feedback/report button	Users can flag incorrect, unclear, or sensitive answers.	P1

6.2 Out of Scope for MVP

- Scholar dashboard and approval workflow.
- Certified scholar-reviewed answer badges.
- Institution-level admin controls.
- Enterprise compliance, custom SLAs, and multi-tenant billing.
- Voice calls, animated avatar, real-time speech pipeline, or telephony.
- Advanced personalization based on religious profiling. Learning level can be stored, but belief profiling should be avoided.

7. User Experience Flow

The product should feel like a clean study assistant, not a heavy enterprise system. The user should be able to ask, read, verify the references, and continue learning with minimal friction.

1. User opens the web app and chooses Ask, Quran, Hadith, or Learn.
2. User asks a question such as: What does Islam say about patience?
3. System retrieves relevant Quran verses, Hadith records, and optional tafsir notes.
4. AI generates a simple explanation using retrieved sources only.
5. Safety guard checks whether the answer becomes a ruling, fatwa, or sensitive judgement.
6. User sees the answer, references, related topics, and a save/report option.
7. If the question requires qualified judgement, the system declines and advises asking a scholar.

Example Response Pattern

Answer first in simple language, then show: Quran references, Hadith references, explanation notes, confidence/limits, and related study topics.

8. Recommended Architecture

The standalone version should use a normal web application architecture. The goal is speed, simplicity, and control. Avoid rebuilding an enterprise AI platform at the start.

Layer	Recommended Choice	Purpose
Frontend	Next.js or React	Chat UI, Quran/Hadith pages, learning paths, saved notes.
Backend API	FastAPI or Node.js	Authentication, chat sessions, retrieval, safety checks, user data.
Primary database	PostgreSQL	Users, conversations, source records, saved topics.
Vector search	pgvector or Qdrant	Semantic search across Quran, Hadith, tafsir, and lessons.
AI model	OpenAI/Claude now; local model later	Generate explanations using retrieved sources.
Auth	Clerk, Supabase Auth, or custom JWT	Login, user profile, subscription later.
Admin tools	Simple internal dashboard	Review reports, manage sources,

Layer	Recommended Choice	Purpose
		inspect unsafe queries.

9. Core System Flow

The answer engine should follow a retrieval-first pattern. The AI should not answer directly from model memory when source material is required.

System Flow

Frontend -> Backend API -> Query classifier -> Source retrieval -> AI explanation -> Safety guard -> Response with references -> Save conversation/logs

- Query classifier decides whether the user is asking for Quran, Hadith, general learning, or a ruling-style answer.
- Retriever searches Quran, Hadith, tafsir notes, and learning content.
- Answer generator explains only from retrieved material.
- Safety guard blocks fatwa-style outputs, sectarian conflict, sensitive personal rulings, and unsupported claims.
- Response renderer displays references clearly and separates explanation from source text.

10. Database Concept

Table	Key Fields	Purpose
users	id, name, email, role, plan	Basic user account and subscription state later.
quran_verses	surah, ayah, arabic_text, translation, translator	Quran source database.
hadith_records	collection, book, number, text, grading, reference	Hadith source database.
tafsir_notes	surah, ayah, source, text, language	Optional tafsir context for later source depth.
conversations	user_id, title, created_at	Conversation sessions.
messages	conversation_id, role, content, references	User and assistant messages.
saved_topics	user_id, topic, notes, references	Personal study and saved learning material.
safety_logs	query, reason, action, severity	Blocked/refused/sensitive query monitoring.
source_reports	user_id, source_id, issue, status	User correction and feedback flow.

11. AI Answer Rules

These rules should be implemented before launch. They are more important than advanced features because the product operates in a sensitive religious-learning context.

- Do not issue fatwas or binding religious rulings.
- Do not claim to be a scholar, imam, mufti, or religious authority.
- Use retrieved Quran/Hadith/source material for answers that require references.
- Show references separately and clearly.

- When a topic has different scholarly views, say that qualified scholars may differ and avoid declaring one ruling as final.
- For personal cases such as divorce, inheritance, oaths, medical ethics, major sin, conflict, abuse, or legal matters, advise the user to consult a qualified scholar or relevant professional.
- If source confidence is low, say so instead of guessing.
- Avoid sectarian attacks, inflammatory language, and unsupported claims.

12. Citation and Scholar Review Strategy

The scholar layer should be added later, but basic source references should exist from day one. Removing all references would make FaithBrains indistinguishable from a generic chatbot. The right approach is progressive trust.

Phase	Citation / Review Level	What It Means
Phase 1 - MVP	Basic references	Show surah/ayah, hadith collection, hadith number, and source name where available.
Phase 2 - Trust layer	Detailed provenance	Add translator, tafsir source, hadith grading, retrieval confidence, and source comparison.
Phase 3 - Scholar layer	Scholar-certified answers	Add scholar review queue, approved answer badges, review notes, and institution controls.

13. Roadmap

Phase	Timeline	Deliverables
Project setup	1-2 weeks	Repo, design system, database schema, auth, source import pipeline, first UI screens.
MVP build	4-8 weeks	Chat, Quran lookup, Hadith lookup, basic references, safety guard, saved topics.
Private beta	8-12 weeks	Invite early users, measure answer quality, collect reports, improve retrieval.
Public beta	3-4 months	Launch stable web app, add onboarding, learning paths, subscriptions later.
Trust layer	3-6 months	Tafsir depth, hadith grading visibility, stronger citation UI, admin review tools.
Scholar layer	6-12 months	Scholar dashboard, certified answers, institution mode, approved content badges.

14. Monetization Plan

Monetization should come after the MVP proves usage and retention. Start with free access to reduce friction, then add paid features around saved learning, unlimited usage, advanced study tools, and institutional accounts.

Plan	Possible Price	Includes	Target User
Free	\$0	Limited questions, Quran/Hadith search, basic references.	Casual learners
Supporter	\$5/month	Higher limits, saved notes, learning paths, export options.	Engaged learners
Institution	Custom	Admin tools, custom learning paths, reviewed content controls.	Mosques, schools, organizations
Enterprise	Custom later	Custom corpus, compliance, support, scholar network.	Large institutions

15. Success Metrics

Metric	Definition	Target Direction
Referenced-answer rate	Percentage of source-based answers that show references.	As close to 100% as possible
No-fatwa adherence	Percentage of ruling-style questions refused or redirected correctly.	100%
Retrieval usefulness	User rating that references were relevant.	Improve weekly
Saved-topic rate	Percentage of users saving lessons or answers.	Shows study value
Report rate	Percentage of answers flagged as wrong/unclear.	Reduce over time
Return usage	Users coming back weekly.	Core retention metric

16. Risks and Mitigation

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
AI gives a religious ruling	High	Hard no-fatwa guard, refusal templates, red-team tests, safety logs.
Weak or misattributed Hadith	High	Store collection, number, grading, and display uncertainty where needed.
Unsourced answer sounds authoritative	High	Retrieval-first answer generation and visible source section.
Sectarian or sensitive dispute	High	Neutral phrasing, acknowledge differences, defer to qualified scholars.
Too much scope too early	Medium	Text-first MVP; postpone voice, avatar, enterprise, and scholar dashboard.
Bad source import quality	High	Validate imports, keep provenance fields, run source QA before beta.

17. Immediate Project Checklist

- Create new repository and project board.
- Finalize MVP feature list and UI wireframes.
- Select Quran translation source and Hadith source dataset with licensing checks.
- Design database schema for Quran, Hadith, conversations, references, and safety logs.
- Build retrieval pipeline and first chat endpoint.
- Implement no-fatwa guardrail before external testing.
- Create the first web UI: Ask, Quran, Hadith, Learn, Saved.
- Run internal testing with 100-200 common Islamic learning questions.
- Prepare private beta and feedback collection.

18. Final Recommendation

Start FaithBrains as a focused standalone product. Do not begin with AvatarOS, voice/avatar infrastructure, enterprise architecture, or scholar operations. Build the simplest useful version first: Quran search, Hadith search, Islamic learning answers, references, saved learning, and strict refusal of fatwa-style answers.

Once users are actively using the product, add the trust layer: deeper citations, tafsir provenance, hadith grading visibility, source correction workflow, and finally scholar-certified content. This sequence reduces build risk and allows the product to prove demand before operational complexity is added.

Build Order

1) Product utility first. 2) Source quality second. 3) Scholar certification third. 4) Institutions and enterprise last.

Reference Note

This standalone proposal is adapted from the original FaithBrains plan by removing AvatarOS-specific platform assumptions and moving scholar-reviewed certification to a later implementation phase. The original core modules - Quran Consultation, Hadith Consultation, and Islamic Learning Assistant - are retained as the foundation of the new project.